2026 NEBRASKA GENERAL ELECTION

Senate, Governor & Generic Ballot: Toplines & Crosstabs

FIELD DATES: SEPTEMBER 14–16, 2026 • N=500 LIKELY VOTERS
MODE: ONLINE PANEL • MARGIN OF ERROR: ±4.4 PTS (95% CONFIDENCE)

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2026 Nebraska Senate

Q5. If the election for U.S. Senate in Nebraska were held today, and the candidates were the following, for whom would you vote?

Response	Result
Pete Ricketts (R)	**52%**
Dan Osborn (I)	**48%**

500	±4.4	Sep 14–16
LIKELY VOTERS	MARGIN OF ERROR, PTS	2026 FIELD DATES

Sen. Pete Ricketts leads independent challenger Dan Osborn 52% to 48% in a rematch of Nebraska's closely-watched 2024 contest, a 4-point margin that falls within the survey's margin of error. The race remains competitive, with no undecided option offered given the two-candidate ballot test.

U.S. Senate — Crosstabulations

Weighted percentages by subgroup among likely voters (n=500). Coll. = four-year degree; DNV = did not vote in 2024.

		Gender		Age				Race				Education		Cong. District			2024 Vote			
Response	**Overall**	**Male**	**Female**	**18-29**	**30-44**	**45-64**	**65+**	**White**	**Hisp.**	**Black**	**Other**	**Coll.**	**No Coll.**	**NE-1**	**NE-2**	**NE-3**	**Trump**	**Harris**	**Other**	**DNV**
Ricketts (R)	52%	57%	47%	36%	42%	47%	68%	56%	38%	4%	49%	49%	55%	49%	40%	68%	84%	5%	56%	52%
Osborn (I)	48%	43%	53%	64%	58%	53%	32%	44%	62%	96%	51%	51%	45%	51%	60%	32%	16%	95%	44%	48%
% of Sample (weighted)	*100%*	*49%*	*51%*	*13%*	*20%*	*31%*	*36%*	*86%*	*6%*	*4%*	*3%*	*46%*	*54%*	*35%*	*33%*	*32%*	*55%*	*38%*	*1%*	*6%*

2026 Nebraska Governor

Q4. If the election for Governor of Nebraska were held today, who would you vote for?

Response	Result
Jim Pillen (R)	**53%**
Lynne Walz (D)	**36%**
Rick Beard	**6%**
Brett Lindstrom	**5%**

500
LIKELY VOTERS

±4.4
MARGIN OF ERROR, PTS

Sep 14–16
2026 FIELD DATES

Gov. Jim Pillen holds a commanding 17-point lead over state Sen. Lynne Walz, 53% to 36%, a gap well outside the survey's margin of error. Independent candidates Rick Beard and Brett Lindstrom draw 6% and 5%, respectively, combining for 11% of the vote outside the two major-party candidates.

Governor — Crosstabulations

Weighted percentages by subgroup among likely voters (n=500). Coll. = four-year degree; DNV = did not vote in 2024.

		Gender		Age				Race				Education		Cong. District			2024 Vote			
Response	**Overall**	**Male**	**Female**	**18-29**	**30-44**	**45-64**	**65+**	**White**	**Hisp.**	**Black**	**Other**	**Coll.**	**No Coll.**	**NE-1**	**NE-2**	**NE-3**	**Trump**	**Harris**	**Other**	**DNV**
Pillen (R)	53%	60%	46%	37%	45%	51%	65%	58%	37%	0%	18%	43%	61%	52%	39%	67%	82%	12%	47%	41%
Walz (D)	36%	31%	40%	48%	34%	40%	28%	32%	37%	96%	48%	44%	28%	38%	48%	22%	7%	78%	22%	33%
Beard	6%	5%	7%	14%	3%	5%	5%	5%	14%	1%	16%	5%	7%	6%	4%	8%	6%	5%	12%	11%
Lindstrom	5%	4%	7%	1%	17%	4%	1%	5%	11%	3%	18%	8%	3%	4%	10%	3%	5%	4%	19%	14%
% of Sample (weighted)	*100%*	*49%*	*51%*	*13%*	*20%*	*31%*	*36%*	*86%*	*6%*	*4%*	*3%*	*46%*	*54%*	*35%*	*32%*	*33%*	*55%*	*38%*	*1%*	*6%*

Generic Congressional Ballot

Q6. If the midterm elections for Congress were held today, which party's candidate would you be more likely to vote for in your district?

Response	Result
Republican	**59%**
Democrat	**41%**

Nebraska's Republican lean shows clearly on the generic ballot, with Republicans holding an 18-point edge, 59% to 41%, on the general midterm House question — a wider margin than either the top-of-ticket Senate or Governor tests.

		Gender		Age				Race				Education		Cong. District			2024 Vote			
Response	Overall	Male	Female	18-29	30-44	45-64	65+	White	Hisp.	Black	Other	Coll.	No Coll.	NE-1	NE-2	NE-3	Trump	Harris	Other	DNV
Republican	59%	65%	54%	54%	51%	53%	71%	64%	46%	4%	39%	53%	65%	56%	49%	72%	93%	11%	66%	49%
Democrat	41%	35%	46%	46%	49%	47%	29%	36%	54%	96%	61%	47%	35%	44%	51%	28%	7%	89%	34%	51%
% of Sample (weighted)	*100%*	*49%*	*51%*	*13%*	*20%*	*31%*	*36%*	*86%*	*6%*	*4%*	*3%*	*46%*	*54%*	*35%*	*32%*	*33%*	*55%*	*38%*	*1%*	*6%*

Osborn's Perceived Voting Alignment

Q9. If elected to the Senate, do you think Dan Osborn would vote more like a:

Response	Result
Neither / independent	**47%**
Democrat	**42%**
Republican	**11%**

Plurality of voters, 47%, see Osborn voting more like an independent than aligning with either party, while 42% expect him to vote more like a Democrat and just 11% expect Republican-aligned votes — a perception gap that may help explain why Osborn runs closer than a generic Democrat would in a state this red.

		Gender		Age				Race				Education		Cong. District			2024 Vote			
Response	Overall	Male	Female	18-29	30-44	45-64	65+	White	Hisp.	Black	Other	Coll.	No Coll.	NE-1	NE-2	NE-3	Trump	Harris	Other	DNV
Republican	11%	18%	5%	31%	14%	7%	7%	12%	0%	21%	4%	8%	14%	12%	7%	15%	9%	16%	21%	10%
Democrat	42%	39%	45%	28%	32%	47%	48%	46%	7%	22%	24%	39%	44%	42%	37%	47%	64%	10%	69%	39%
Neither	47%	43%	50%	42%	54%	46%	45%	42%	93%	57%	72%	52%	42%	46%	56%	38%	28%	74%	10%	51%
% of Sample (weighted)	*100%*	*49%*	*51%*	*13%*	*20%*	*31%*	*36%*	*86%*	*6%*	*4%*	*3%*	*46%*	*54%*	*35%*	*32%*	*33%*	*55%*	*38%*	*1%*	*6%*

Trump Job Approval

Q7. Do you approve or disapprove of the job Donald Trump is doing as president?

Response	Result
Disapprove	**58%**
Approve	**42%**

President Trump's job approval sits underwater in Nebraska at 42% approve / 58% disapprove, a net -16 rating, with disapproval running highest among voters under 45 and among non-white respondents.

		Gender		Age				Race				Education		Cong. District			2024 Vote			
Response	Overall	Male	Female	18-29	30-44	45-64	65+	White	Hisp.	Black	Other	Coll.	No Coll.	NE-1	NE-2	NE-3	Trump	Harris	Other	DNV
Approve	42%	46%	38%	32%	32%	41%	52%	45%	37%	0%	19%	38%	45%	41%	29%	55%	68%	7%	0%	31%
Disapprove	58%	54%	62%	68%	68%	59%	48%	55%	63%	100%	81%	62%	55%	59%	71%	45%	32%	93%	100%	69%
% of Sample (weighted)	*100%*	*49%*	*51%*	*13%*	*20%*	*31%*	*36%*	*86%*	*6%*	*4%*	*3%*	*46%*	*54%*	*35%*	*32%*	*33%*	*55%*	*38%*	*1%*	*6%*

Ricketts Job Approval

Q8. Do you approve or disapprove of the job Pete Ricketts is doing as senator?

Response	Result
Disapprove	**44%**
Approve	**42%**
Unsure	**13%**

Sen. Ricketts' job approval is essentially split, with 44% disapproving and 42% approving of his performance; 13% remain unsure. (Figures reflect rounding and may not sum to 100%.)

		Gender		Age				Race				Education		Cong. District			2024 Vote			
Response	Overall	Male	Female	18-29	30-44	45-64	65+	White	Hisp.	Black	Other	Coll.	No Coll.	NE-1	NE-2	NE-3	Trump	Harris	Other	DNV
Approve	42%	43%	42%	24%	28%	38%	60%	44%	53%	2%	17%	40%	44%	46%	33%	46%	66%	10%	13%	26%
Disapprove	44%	48%	41%	53%	45%	48%	38%	44%	28%	95%	28%	47%	42%	45%	50%	39%	22%	79%	78%	30%
Unsure	13%	9%	17%	23%	27%	14%	3%	12%	19%	2%	55%	13%	14%	9%	17%	15%	12%	10%	8%	44%
% of Sample (weighted)	*100%*	*49%*	*51%*	*13%*	*20%*	*31%*	*36%*	*86%*	*6%*	*4%*	*3%*	*46%*	*54%*	*35%*	*32%*	*33%*	*55%*	*38%*	*1%*	*6%*

Methodology

Sample Design

This survey was conducted among a sample of 500 likely voters in Nebraska, fielded September 14–16, 2026. Respondents were recruited and surveyed online via an online panel. Respondents were screened for registration status and likelihood of voting in the 2026 general election.

Weighting

Data were weighted using iterative proportional fitting (raking) to known population targets for gender, age, race/ethnicity, and education, based on the Nebraska Secretary of State voter file and U.S. Census Bureau estimates of the state's registered voter population.

Sponsorship & Independence

This survey was conceived and designed by Wedgewood Polls and funded through a crowdfunding campaign organized by a group of individual contributors on Election Twitter. No candidate, campaign, party, or outside organization sponsored this release, and no funder had input into question wording, sample design, or the analysis presented here.

Margin of Error

At the 95% confidence level, the statewide sample of 500 likely voters carries a margin of error of ±4.4 percentage points. Margins of error for individual crosstabulation subgroups are larger and increase as subgroup size decreases.

Quality Controls

Standard data quality measures were applied throughout fielding, including speeder and straight-lining detection, open-end response review, and removal of duplicate or inconsistent respondents prior to weighting and analysis.

Contact

For questions regarding methodology, full topline results, or media inquiries, contact Wedgewood Polls.

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